AI Primer : Training Curriculum — Recommended Learning Path

Topic	Description & Importance	Overview (IBM)	Tutorial
1. Foundational LLM Mechanics	How AI works: Tools like ChatGPT and Gemini learn language patterns from vast amounts of training data. Rather than looking up answers, they respond word-by-word, statistically choosing the most likely next word. This drives their fluent, confident tone—even when wrong. Clear accurate user inputs, are essential to guiding its predictions towards accuracy.	3Blue1Brown: Large Language Models Explained Briefly (~8 min) IBM: How LLMs Work (~6 min)	IBM: Why LLMs Hallucinate (~10 min)
2. Prompt Engineering	Telling the AI who to act as, what exactly to do and which rules to follow. Precise wording and a clear role have more chance of getting the right answer first time; vague requests get vague results.	IBM: The Perfect Prompt (~13 min)	Prompt Engineering Course (~38 min)
3. Context Engineering	Giving the AI the right background information — the email chain, the client brief, the spreadsheet and other documents you are working from — and managing what it holds in view, keeps long conversations 'on topic' and stops it forgetting earlier instructions or inventing answers.	IBM: Context Windows (~12 min)	Context Engineering Course (~30 min)
4. Microsoft Copilot	AI built into Word, Excel, Outlook and Teams, so staff get the benefit inside the tools they already use every day.	Microsoft: Copilot Features Overview (~7 min)	Copilot in Word, Excel and PowerPoint (~17 min)
5. Retrieval-Augmented Generation (RAG)	Ask a question and the AI searches the information repositories — contracts, emails, procedures, project documents and more — then answers using what it found and names the document and page it came from.	IBM: What is RAG? (~7 min)	Any Document, Full Control, Full Privacy, Local - AnythingLLM (~15 min)
6. AI Agents	AI that carries out a job end to end, not just answers a question — useful for the repetitive multi-step tasks that eat up staff time. Copilot Agents require information sources to be stored in Microsoft's cloud (e.g. documents, spreadsheets, email archives etc.).	IBM: What Are Agents? (~12 min)	Build your own AI Agent in Copilot Agent Builder (~28 min) Creating no-code AI AGENTS that run locally on your laptop | AnythingLLM (~17 min)

RECOMMENDED: Complete the modules in order — each builds on the previous one.